

A King After God's Own Heart

Most of us know the story. A shepherd boy with a rock. A giant with a sword.

My younger brother had a David and Goliath birthday party when we were kids. My dad is an artist, and he drew a 9-foot(-ish) giant warrior on butcher paper. He was extremely grumpy and mean looking (Goliath—not my dad), fitting to his harsh words in the story quite well. Then we took turns throwing globs of no-bake cookie dough at the homemade giant.

By experiencing this story through a laid-back, very-kid-friendly lens, we can learn a lot, even subconsciously, about God fighting our battles, standing up for God and His people, and a seemingly warranted fear of being hit with things in the forehead.

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As adults rereading this story or watching it through new feature films, we may begin to wonder what the agendas were of different storytellers. The creators of the films and TV shows, writers of the Bible storybooks, and even the original authors who told this story to the Hebrew people throughout history—what was their purpose in highlighting or showcasing the moments, the dialogue, or the key details that they did?

If we've learned anything going through the Text with BEMA, we have to assume there is a lot more going on than Marty and Brent—or years of scholars—have unearthed. And this is a good thing!

What about the early readers and intended audience of the time? Is it about faith? Good versus evil? Cowardly versus self-sacrificing leadership?

Sure! And probably a whole lot more.

Yet when we read these stories through our more Westernized lenses it is so easy for us to pull one of these lessons, like the one I took away from throwing cookie dough at a giant sketch, and believe we've figured the story out. However, we can't forget to take a step back and ask, yet again, *what is this story telling us about God?*—about his character, how and who He works through, what He desires for all of His creation and all of humankind.

So, let's do that: What do these early events in David's story, because there are many chapters coming, show us about God?

Perhaps this is shown in what drove David to act when he arrived at the battlefield, because what David concerns himself with in much of his story is *hallowing* the name of God.

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Whether it is due to his earlier anointing from Samuel or something that was imprinted on his soul even before this moment, David was ready to fight—to throw his stone—the moment he heard Goliath’s taunts, and if the current King of Israel wasn’t going to stop it, why not him?

I’m reminded of characters earlier in the Text like Jacob. Those who, like David, were not perfect, but were willing to *do* something. God can work with those who are ready to try, those who are willing to throw their stone and let God guide it. Yet, if we choose to stay safely in our tent hiding behind our soldiers and never let loose our stone, what can God do with that?

**It is God that
will make
the impact.**

At BEMA and Impact Campus Ministries, we recognize that the things we do are like stones—campus ministries in Florida or Oregon, podcast recordings, virtual meetings, book events—ones we throw with the best of our ability and in good faith that God will carry them where they are needed. It is God who will make the impact.

May we remember that God has given each of us stones we can throw. The gifts and talents you have. Your welding and machining skills, your love for children with exceptionalities, your desire to stay at home with your kids, your passion for creating art from nothing, your words that naturally fall onto the page as you write, your gentle hands that work to heal the sick, your friendly voice as you answer the business phone.

God wants you to do what you love; He made you with those gifts and callings, and this story shows us that he wants us to do it together with Him.

May we remember that God wants us to partner with Him to bless the world, putting ourselves in the places where we can bless and protect others and continue to hallow His name. Because when we do, something quite miraculous occurs.

PRAYER

*You have made every little thing that needs done in this world a holy, sacred calling.
Placing us all in the crossroads of our cities and neighborhoods,
our homes and communities, to bring shalom to chaos,
and free the world from oppression.
We surrender ourselves, our lives, to You.
Help us throw our stone, remember where we came from, and know when to say enough.
May the works of our hands and hearts,
our voices and minds, always hallow Your name.*

Amen

THE FOUR PILLARS

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

What Text might you spend more time in? What might be important to memorize or meditate over? What other parts of the Text might enlighten your reading of 1 Samuel?



COMMUNITY

How are you, or your community, choosing to lead others? How might your community be placed at the crossroads of your communities and throw your stone?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who are you bringing alongside you to show how to hallow God's name? How could throwing your stone impact those you're near? Or how has it before?



WRESTLING

What are you wrestling with in this story? The numerology and imagery of Goliath and Saul and David? What sits a little funny or stands out to you still?



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 2



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases that we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*True success is developing intimacy with God. In Session 1, we encountered the idea of “Creating Space for God” in our lives. We believe that **if we do our part of creating that space, God will fill it** as He desires. You’re already doing this as you dive into the Text and jump into a place to discuss. God will meet you in these places! Look for places the Holy Spirit can do work in and through you as you go about your everyday life.*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

*We believe that young adults are shaping the **future of this world**. Jesus modeled a ministry of discipling young adults, and that approach has and will work. If you are a college student who is listening, we want this material to be directly helpful to your pursuits. If you are not a college student, we want to challenge you to come alongside one and work together.*

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*This isn’t only for church or Bible study; this is about what we do every day. How we do our job and how it may take advantage of or bring life to others is something God says is central to our presence in the world. Justice is very much something God cares about. Does our physical work (our 9–5 job) bring shalom or chaos? Does it exploit creation? The way we manage our employees, interact with customers or coworkers, care for our children, or create products can provide relief to others. **The work we do every day is sacred and matters!***